

Qilong Yu (Leo)

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EDUCATION

Master of Science in Quantitative Finance, University of California-San Diego *Sept. 2024-Aug. 2025*

Core Modules: Investment Analysis, Empirical Finance, Computational Finance Methods, Econometrics (PhD Course).

Honors: UC Scholarship (\$10,000)

Bachelor of Science Degree in Finance, Kean University (Wenzhou China & Union New Jersey) *Sept. 2020-Jun. 2024*

GPA: 3.824/4 **Honors:** Overseas Study Scholarship (2022), Dean's Scholarship (2021,2023), Dean's list.

Core Modules: Corporate Finance, Investments, Derivatives, The Preparation and Analysis of Financial Statements, Big Data Computing, Matrix & Linear Algebra, Calculus, Business Statistics and Application, Internet Marketing, Consumer Behavior, Management Information Systems.

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Greater internal pay disparity, greater difficulty in forecasting? Evidence from China (February. 2025-Present)

Solo Research Project

- This study examines the impact of corporate behavior on analyst forecasts. Preliminary findings show that the greater the internal pay gap, the lower the analyst forecast accuracy. Further investigation of related factors shows that the company's adaptability plays a full mediating role, that is, internal wage inequality significantly weakens the company's adaptability, leading to larger analyst forecast errors.
- The next phase of the study will focus on disentangling endogenous and exogenous influences to refine the causal mechanisms underlying these relationships.
- My Contribution: Literature Review, Data Acquisition and Processing, Baseline Analysis, and Robustness Checks.

Racial conflicts and workplace application of AI (January. 2025-Present)

Co-author and Research Assistant - Led by Professor Yunfei Zhao of Kean University (Wenzhou).

- This study explores how racial conflicts affect the application of AI in American companies. We assume that racial conflicts exacerbate labor mobility and union demands, increase market frictions and financing costs, and prompt companies to adopt AI to reduce dependence on manual labor, while alleviating rising financing costs and improving corporate performance.
- My Contribution: Database Development, Data-Driven Analysis (Racial Conflict Index construction), Causal Inference (PSM & DID tests).

Examining the examined: imperial examination records and texts in China (August. 2024-Present)

Research Assistant - Led by Professor Letian Zhang of Harvard University.

- This study aims to analyze the relationship between the social background and system of ancient China and the educational background, family relationships, and texts of the "Keju examination (Imperial examination)" candidates
- My contribution: Literature collection and organization, database construction, meeting minutes and presentations.

Natural Disasters and AI Use: A Study Based on Enterprise Investment (May. 2024-July. 2024)

Research Assistant - Led by Professor Yunfei Zhao of Kean University (Wenzhou).

- This project aims to promote more rational investment choices for enterprises during natural disasters by studying the utilization rate of AI under different backgrounds of natural disaster events.
- My contribution: Research relevant literature, schedule timelines, design experiments, data cleaning, data analysis (regression analysis, robustness testing), group leadership, and oral presentation.

Do female analysts know politics better? Evidence from China (March. 2023-August. 2023)

Co-author and Research Assistant - Led by Professor Yunfei Zhao of Kean University (Wenzhou).

- This research analysed the predictive accuracy and optimism of Chinese male and female analysts under political intervention conditions, and concluded that female analysts predict more accurately but less optimistically than men. And educational inequality and family interference factors have exacerbated this phenomenon. This result provides a reference for companies to choose analysts in the future.
- My contribution: Related literature reading and management, data collection (Python-OCR, reptile, CSMAR database), data cleaning,

time planning, model design, data analysis (regression analysis, robustness testing, endogeneity testing), international conference presentations.

- Accepted by *Southwestern Finance Association Annual Meeting*, *The Annual Conference of the British Accounting Review*, and *2023 Vietnam Symposium in Banking and Finance (VSBF2023)* and delivered a speech at the conference. Received funding from the WKU research project (WKUSPF202309). Preparing to submit to the *International Economic and Financial Review*, *Financial Research Express*, or equivalent journal ASAP.

Local economic uncertainty, bank efficiency, and financial risk (Nov. 2022-Sept. 2023)

Co-author and Research Assistant - Led by Professor Ahmed W. Alam of Kean University (USA).

- Investigated the impact of state-level economic policy uncertainty (SEPU) on bank efficiency and financial risk using a sample of 9,948 U.S. banks (2011–2021). Found that efficient cost management helps banks mitigate financial risks associated with high SEPU, a result consistent across alternative SEPU, risk, and efficiency measures and matched bank samples. This study provides insights into managing financial risk amid economic uncertainty.
- My contribution: Research relevant literature, schedule timelines, design experiments, data cleaning, data analysis (regression analysis, robustness testing, endogeneity testing), group leadership, and oral presentation.
- Publish results at Kean University Student Research Day in 2023. We have submitted to the *Economic Express* and are currently under review.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Part Time Assistant in Financial Services Department, PwC Consulting Co., Ltd. (Feb. 2024-Sept. 2024) Beijing, China.

- Participate in a project team of a certain bank, assess the compliance and reliability of bank behavior, and conduct risk assessment and investment recommendations for investments in banks and related enterprises.
- Using Python for file transcription and data analysis, including file editing, data visualization, and risk model construction.

Part Time Assistant in Investment Bank Department, China Securities Co., Ltd. (Jul. 2023-Aug. 2023) Beijing, China.

- Participate in the daily affairs of the merger and acquisition project team, independently complete research reports on the new energy vehicle and chip industries.
- Analyze the financial statements of the target company, use Excel and Python to analyze the company's financial data, and successfully conduct financial modeling.

Assistant in Financial Department, Shanghai Powerlong Commercial Real Estate Co., Ltd. (Jun. 2022-Aug. 2022) Suqian, China.

- Participate in the collection and analysis of financial data, including cost auditing, cash flow analysis, comparative analysis, etc.
- Successfully established a financial model, utilized market and company data to predict future financial performance, and conducted sensitivity analysis on budget proposals.

SCHOOL EXPERIENCE

- College Student Assistant (Student Advisory Council) in College of Business and Public Management, Kean University (Wenzhou). From Sept. 2023 to Jun. 2024.
- Student Editor in the Centre of International Student, Kean University (Wenzhou & USA). From Sept. 2022 to Apr. 2023.
- President in the basketball club, Kean University (Wenzhou). From Sept. 2021 to Jun. 2022.

OTHER INFORMATION

- Languages: English, Mandarin (Native).
- Software: MS Office (macro-capable), Stata, Python, R Studio, Bloomberg, Wind and SPSS.
- Certifications & Training: Bloomberg Market Concept; Top 10 in Zhejiang Provincial Finals in “Job Hunting Competition” organized by ACCA; “Best intern” in China Everbright Bank Young Talent Internship.
- Hobbies: Play the guitar (for 15 years), making videos (a blogger), doing crafts, baking, and swimming.